

The Pritikin Program

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

20.31.1

Manual Section Title

The Pritikin Program

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

08/12/2010

Implementation Date

10/25/2010

Description Information

Benefit Category

Intensive Cardiac Rehabilitation Program

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

The Pritikin diet was designed and adopted by Nathan Pritikin in 1955. The diet was modeled after the diet of the Tarahumara Indians in Mexico, which consisted of 10% fat, 13% protein, 75-80% carbohydrates and provided 15-20 grams per day of crude fiber with only 75 mg/day of cholesterol. Over the years, the Pritikin Program (also known as the Pritikin Longevity Program) evolved into a comprehensive program that is provided in a physician's office and incorporates a specific diet (10%-15% of calories from fat, 15%-20% from protein, 65%-75% from complex carbohydrates), exercise, and counseling lasting 21-26 days. An optional residential component is also available for participants.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

Effective for claims with dates of service on and after August 12, 2010, the Pritikin Program meets the intensive cardiac rehabilitation (ICR) program requirements set forth by Congress in §1861(eee)(4)(A) of the Social Security Act and in regulations at 42 C.F.R. §410.49(c) and, as such, has been included on the list of approved ICR programs available at <http://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Medicare-General-Information/MedicareApprovedFacilities/>.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Effective August 12, 2010, if a specific ICR program is not included on the list as a Medicare-approved ICR program, it is non-covered.

D. Other

N/A

(This NCD last reviewed August 2010.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 12497 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

125

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R125NCD.pdf>

Revision History

01/2024 - Transmittal 12318 issued October 19, 2023, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 12441, dated January 3, 2024, to add FISS to BR 13390.11 and to add clarifying verbiage to business requirement 13390.12. All other information remains the same. ([TN 12441](#)) (CR13390)

10/2023 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a quarterly maintenance update of ICD-10 coding conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determinations (NCDs). No policy is being changed as a result of these updates. ([TN 12318](#)) (CR13390)

08/2022 - Transmittal 11545 dated August 5, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11584, dated, August 31, 2022. ([TN 11584](#)) (CR12822)

08/2022 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates to specific NCDs. ([TN 11545](#)) (CR12822)

06/2022 - Transmittal 11400, dated May 4, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11460, dated, June 17, 2022, to update NCD 90.2, NGS, spreadsheet to conform with changes in CR 12124, and change the implementation date for all business requirements except 12705.6 to 30 days from issuance of this correction. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11460](#)) (CR12705)

05/2022 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11400](#)) (CR12705)

01/2022 - Transmittal 11068, dated October 21, 2021, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11179, dated, January 12, 2022 to revise the attachment for NCD 110.24, CAR-T, to add business requirement 12480.10.1 by adding generic unspecified procedure codes, to clarify coverage and claims processing in the policy section and to review the implementation date. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11179](#)) (CR12480)

10/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11068](#)) (CR12480)

05/2019 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 2298](#)) (CR11229)

05/2017 - This change request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1854](#)) (CR10086)

02/2017 - This change request (CR) is the 11th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). These NCD

coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates as follows: CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, CR9540, CR9631, CR9751, and CR9861, as well as in CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1798](#)) (CR9982)

03/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1199](#)) ([TN 1199](#)) (CR 8197)

09/2010 - Effective for claims with dates of service August 12, 2010, and after, CMS has determined that the Ornish Program for Reversing Heart Disease and the Pritikin Program each meet the ICR program requirements set forth by Congress in section 1861(eee)(4)(A) of the Social Security Act and in regulations at 42 CFR 410.49(c) and, as such, both programs have been included on the list of approved ICR programs available at <http://www.cms.gov/MedicareApprovedFacilities/>. Effective date 08/12/2010 Implementation date 10/25/2010 ([TN 125](#)) (CR 7113)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- Original Consideration for Intensive Cardiac Rehabilitation (ICR) Program - Pritikin Program (CAG-00418N)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
The Pritikin Program	1	08/12/2010 - N/A	You are here

